Speak to Travel — 12-Week Intensive English Conversation Program

Teacher's book for private, 1-on-1 (or pairs) conversation classes. **Students:** adult Portuguese speakers (40+ usually) who studied *some* English, understand a little, but **freeze when they have to speak** — especially before a trip or an interview. **Duration:** 12 weeks maximum · 3 sessions per week · 60 minutes = **36 sessions** (≈36 hours of speaking + homework). **Only conversation.** Grammar appears only when it unlocks a sentence the student needs to *say*.

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Companion files:

- **File 3 (Error Guide)** — the mistakes Portuguese speakers make (pronunciation, false friends, "translated" sentences) and how to fix each one
- **File 4 (Question Bank)** — interview & role-play question bank (airport immigration, consulate, hotel, doctor, emergencies)
- **File 5 (Student Sheets)** — printable student sheets: diagnostic, "My Story" card, weekly self-check, final certificate checklist

1. The promise (and the honest limit)

What you promise the student:

> "In 12 weeks you will be able to travel alone, pass immigration, check in, order food, ask for help, handle a problem, talk about yourself for 2 minutes, and survive a 10-minute conversation with a stranger — without panic."

What you do NOT promise: fluency. Nobody becomes fluent in 36 hours. Tell the student this on day one — older adults respect honesty, and it lowers anxiety. The real target is roughly **CEFR A2 → B1 in speaking** (CEFR = the European scale A1 → C2 that schools use; A2 = "basic survival", B1 = "can handle most travel situations").

The real problem these students have is not vocabulary. It is:

1. **Fear / blocking** ("trava") — they know the words but can't get them out.
2. **Translating from Portuguese in their head**, sentence by sentence.
3. **Listening speed** — real people talk fast and connect words.
4. **Pronunciation habits** that make them hard to understand (and make them feel embarrassed).

Everything in this program attacks those four things.

2. The method — 7 principles

#	Principle	What it means in class
1	**Student talks 70% of the time**	If you are talking more than the student, stop. Time it once a week.
2	**Chunks, not rules**	Teach whole phrases ("Could I get…?", "I'm looking for…") as one block. Older adults learn blocks faster than rules.
3	**Situation first**	Every lesson is a real travel situation. The question is always: "What would you *say* here?"
4	**Repeat → Vary → Free**	Same phrase 3 ways: repeat it, change one word, then use it in an unscripted role-play.
5	**Correct smart, not everything**	During free talk, write mistakes down silently; correct 3–5 at the end. Correct on the spot only when meaning breaks.
6	**Survival tools before perfection**	Week 1 teaches how to say *"Sorry, could you repeat that more slowly?"* A student who can ask for help never fully gets stuck.
7	**Spiral**	Every week recycles the previous weeks. Week 12's final interview uses phrases from Week 1.

The "Portuguese bridge" rule

Use Portuguese **only** for: (a) explaining *why* something is wrong, (b) calming anxiety, (c) the first 5 minutes of Week 1. After Week 4, Portuguese is ≤ 5% of class. Make it a game: student pays "1 point" each time they switch to Portuguese without asking "How do you say ___ in English?" (which is *always* allowed — and is itself a phrase to practice).

3. Before Week 1: the diagnostic session

30–45 minutes, free or low cost (also works as your sales meeting — see section 10).

Use the form in **File 5 (Student Sheets)**. It covers:

1. **Goals** (in Portuguese): Where are you going? When? Alone or with family? Is there an interview (visa, immigration, job)? What scares you most?
2. **Speaking sample** (in English, record audio with permission): 6 questions from easy to hard:
   - What's your name? Where are you from?
   - What do you do? / What did you do before you retired?
   - Tell me about your family.
   - What did you do last weekend? *(past tense test)*
   - Why do you want to travel to ___? *(opinion / reasons)*
   - What would you do if you lost your passport? *(hypothetical — most won't manage; that's fine)*
3. **Listening sample:** play 30 seconds of a natural airport or restaurant dialogue. Ask 3 simple questions.
4. **Pronunciation check:** ask them to read: *"I think three hotels have the best rooms. I worked, I visited, I played."* (tests TH, H/R, final -ed, vowel length.)

Score each area 1–5 using the rubric in section 7. Keep the recording — you'll play it back in Week 12. **This "before and after" moment is the single most powerful thing in the course** (and your best marketing, with permission).

Adapting the program:

- Very weak (can't answer the first 3 questions): spend 2 weeks on Phase 1 instead of 1 week per unit; drop Week 11.
- Stronger (handles past tense): compress Weeks 1–2 into one week; add more debate/free talk in Phase 3.
- Has a **specific date** (trip or interview): move the relevant week earlier and repeat its role-play every session until the date.

4. The 60-minute session template

Time	Block	What happens
0–5	**Warm-up chat**	"How was your day?" — real small talk. Note mistakes silently.
5–10	**Recycle**	Quick-fire review: 5 phrases from last class, student must say them fast.
10–25	**New chunks**	8–12 phrases for today's situation. Model → student repeats → student varies. Drill the pronunciation point of the week here.
25–45	**Role-play**	2–3 rounds of the situation. Round 1 with the phrase sheet. Round 2 without. Round 3 you add a "problem" (surprise).
45–55	**Free talk**	Open questions connected to the theme. Student talks, you listen and note.
55–60	**Feedback + homework**	3–5 corrections (write them in the student's notebook / WhatsApp), homework, and one compliment that is *specific and true*.

Golden rule for role-plays: you play the native speaker at *slightly faster than comfortable* speed, using real phrases ("Next, please!", "For here or to go?", "Can I see your passport?"). Speak naturally — don't use "teacher English". The student's job is to survive, not to be perfect.

Weekly rhythm (3 sessions):

- **Session A** — new situation, new chunks.
- **Session B** — same situation, harder role-plays + listening practice.
- **Session C** — "Mission day": mixed review, a longer role-play combining all weeks so far, and the weekly self-check.

5. Program map — 3 phases, 12 weeks

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PHASE 1 — UNLOCK (Weeks 1-4)        "I can say the basics without freezing"
  W1  Survival kit + Who am I?
  W2  My life, my family, my work
  W3  Airport: check-in, security, boarding
  W4  IMMIGRATION & PASSPORT CONTROL  ← checkpoint 1

PHASE 2 — TRAVEL (Weeks 5-8)        "I can handle every travel situation"
  W5  Hotel & accommodation
  W6  Restaurants, cafés, shopping
  W7  Getting around: directions, transport, Uber, tickets
  W8  Problems & emergencies: doctor, pharmacy, lost items  ← checkpoint 2

PHASE 3 — CONVERSE (Weeks 9-12)     "I can have a real conversation"
  W9   Small talk & making friends
  W10  Telling stories (the past) — the trip, my life
  W11  Opinions, plans, preferences — going deeper
  W12  Final interview + real-world mission + graduation  ← final assessment
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6. The 12 weeks, session by session

Each week lists: **Can-do goal · Core chunks · Pronunciation focus · Grammar-in-action (only what's needed) · Role-plays · Free-talk questions · Homework · Brazilian trap of the week.**

WEEK 1 — Survival Kit + Who Am I?

Can-do goal: "I can introduce myself and I never get stuck, because I can ask for help."

Core chunks — Survival kit (teach FIRST, drill every class for 12 weeks):

- Sorry, could you repeat that?
- Could you speak more slowly, please?
- What does ___ mean?
- How do you say ___ in English?
- Sorry, I don't understand. / I didn't catch that.
- Can you write it down, please?
- Just a moment, let me think.
- My English is not perfect, but I'll try.

Core chunks — Introductions:

- Hi, my name is ___. Nice to meet you. / Nice to meet you too.
- I'm from ___, in Brazil. I live in ___.
- I'm ___ years old. *(trap: NOT "I have ___ years")*
- I'm a ___ / I work as a ___ / I'm retired. I used to be a ___.
- I'm married / single / divorced / a widow(er). I have two kids and one grandchild.
- I'm learning English because I want to travel to ___.

Pronunciation focus: the "extra i" (epenthesis). Brazilians say *"Facebook-i"*, *"big-i"*, *"I like-i"*. Drill: *like, work, big, good, book, name, nice, Brazil* — stop the sound dead at the end.

Grammar-in-action: verb TO BE — *I'm / you're / he's / it's* (contracted, the way people talk).

Role-plays:

1. Meeting someone at a party.
2. The person sitting next to you on the plane.
3. *Surprise round:* the teacher talks too fast → the student must use 3 survival phrases.

Free talk: Where are you from? What's your city famous for? Why English, why now?

Homework: Record a 30-second voice message introducing yourself (send on WhatsApp). Write the **"My Story" card** (see **File 5 (Student Sheets)**) — 6 sentences about yourself, which will grow every week.

Brazilian trap: *"I have 55 years."* → **"I'm 55."** and *"I am agree"* → **"I agree."**

WEEK 2 — My Life, My Family, My Work

Can-do goal: "I can talk about myself for 1 minute and ask other people questions."

Core chunks:

- What do you do? / What do you do for a living? → I'm a nurse / I run a small business / I'm retired.
- Where do you work? → I work at a hospital / for a bank / from home.
- How long have you been retired? → For about five years.
- Do you have kids? → Yes, I have a son and a daughter. They're 30 and 27.
- My son lives in ___. That's why I'm traveling.
- What do you like to do in your free time? → I like to cook / walk / read / watch series.
- On weekends I usually ___.
- **Turning it back:** And you? / What about you? / How about you?

Pronunciation focus: H vs. R. Brazilian "R" at the start of a word sounds like English "H" (*"rice"* → *"hice"*). And English "H" is soft air, never a Portuguese "R". Drill pairs: *house / rouse, hot / rot, head / red, happy, hotel, rice, right, Rio.*

Grammar-in-action: present simple for routines + **do/does questions** (*Do you…? Does she…?*). Third-person -s: *she works, he lives.*

Role-plays:

1. Two travelers in a hotel lobby getting to know each other.
2. Speed-dating style: teacher asks 10 quick questions, student answers in ≤ 5 seconds each.
3. Student interviews the teacher (role swap — students rarely practice *asking*).

Free talk: Describe a normal day. What's your best family memory? What job did you love?

Homework: Add 6 sentences to "My Story" card (family + work + hobbies). Watch a 3-minute YouTube video of real people introducing themselves; write down 3 phrases you heard.

Brazilian trap: *"I work in a hospital since 2010."* → **"I've worked at a hospital since 2010."** (teach as a chunk, not as a tense lesson). *"My parents"* = pai e mãe only — not "parentes" (= **relatives**).

WEEK 3 — The Airport: Check-in, Security, Boarding

Can-do goal: "I can check in, go through security and get on my plane without help."

Core chunks — the student says:

- Hi, I'd like to check in. Here's my passport.
- I have one bag to check. / Just a carry-on.
- Could I have a window / an aisle seat, please?
- Is the flight on time? / Which gate is it?
- Where is gate 32? / Where's the restroom?
- Excuse me, is this the line for ___?
- I think I missed my connection. What should I do?

Core chunks — the student must UNDERSTAND (listening):

- *Next, please! / Next in line!*
- *Any bags to check? / Did you pack your bags yourself?*
- *Please put your liquids, laptops and shoes in the bin.*
- *Step forward / Arms up / You're good to go.*
- *Boarding group 3 is now boarding. / This is the final call for…*
- *Your flight has been delayed / canceled / the gate has changed.*

Pronunciation focus: numbers — 13 vs 30, 14 vs 40, 15 vs 50 (stress: thir**TEEN** vs **THIR**ty). Gate numbers, flight numbers, times. Also how people say times: *"ten-fifteen", "a quarter to nine"*.

Grammar-in-action: "I'd like…" and **"Could I…?"** — polite requests (the most useful structure for travel). Contrast with the too-direct *"I want… "*, which can sound rude.

Role-plays:

1. Check-in counter (teacher = agent).
2. Security line (teacher gives fast commands, student acts them out — TPR, great for older learners).
3. *Surprise:* "Your flight is canceled." Student must ask what to do, about another flight, and about a hotel voucher.

Listening: play real airport announcements (search "airport boarding announcement" on YouTube). Student writes the gate and time.

Homework: Learn the alphabet sound-by-sound for **spelling your name** (A/E/I and G/J are always confused by Brazilians). Practice spelling your full name and email out loud.

Brazilian trap: *"I want a window."* → **"Could I have a window seat?"** · *"Where is the bathroom?"* → in the US say **"restroom"**.

WEEK 4 — Immigration & Passport Control ⭐ CHECKPOINT 1

Can-do goal: "I can answer an immigration officer calmly, clearly and briefly."

> This is the week your students fear most. It is usually the reason they hired you. Spend extra time here and **recycle it in every later Session C**.

The 3 golden rules (tell the student in Portuguese):

1. **Answer short, true and direct.** No long stories. No jokes. No lies — ever.
2. **Answer exactly what was asked.** "How long?" → "Two weeks." Not your life story.
3. **If you don't understand, ask.** "Sorry, could you repeat that?" is 100% acceptable. Guessing is not.

Core chunks — typical questions and model answers:

Officer asks	Model answer
What's the purpose of your visit?	Tourism. / I'm visiting my daughter. / For a conference.
How long are you staying?	Two weeks. I go back on May 20th.

Officer asks	Model answer
Where are you staying?	At the Hilton in Orlando. / At my son's house in Boston.
Who are you traveling with?	With my wife. / I'm traveling alone.
What do you do in Brazil?	I'm a retired teacher. / I own a small store.
Have you been here before?	Yes, once, in 2019. / No, this is my first time.
Do you have a return ticket?	Yes, here it is.
How much money are you bringing?	About two thousand dollars, and my credit card.
Anything to declare? / Any food?	No, nothing. / Yes, I have some chocolates.
Do you know anyone here?	Yes, my son lives here. He's a ___.

Important real-world note for the student: At the **US consulate in Brazil**, the visa interview can usually be done in Portuguese — confirm when booking. But at **airport immigration abroad (e.g., US CBP), the conversation is in English.** That is where this week pays off. Always carry printed documents: return ticket, hotel booking / host's address, proof of ties (job, retirement, property) — and say "Here it is" while handing it over.

Pronunciation focus: dates and months — *May twentieth, August third*. Ordinals (1st, 2nd, 3rd, 20th). And **TH** — *third, thirtieth, thank you, three* (tongue between teeth; NOT "f", "t" or "s").

Role-plays: use **File 4 (Question Bank)**. Run 3 officer "personalities": **friendly**, **neutral and fast**, and **serious/suspicious** (lots of follow-up: *"Why two weeks?" "What does your son do?" "Who paid for the ticket?"*). The serious one is where students grow.

CHECKPOINT 1 (Session C): a recorded 5-minute immigration interview + 2-minute self-introduction. Score with the rubric. Compare with the diagnostic.

Brazilian trap: answering "Do you have...?" with just "Have" → **"Yes, I do."** And *"I'm going to stay 15 days"* (fine) — but **"two weeks"** sounds more natural.

WEEK 5 — Hotel & Accommodation

Can-do goal: "I can check in, ask for what I need, and complain politely."

Core chunks:

- Hi, I have a reservation under the name ___.
- I booked a double room for 5 nights.
- What time is breakfast? / Is breakfast included?
- What's the Wi-Fi password?
- Could I have a late check-out? / Can I leave my bags here?
- **Complaining politely:** *I'm sorry to bother you, but...* the air conditioning isn't working / the room is too noisy / there are no towels.
- Would it be possible to change rooms?

- Could you call a taxi for me? / Can you recommend a good restaurant nearby?
- Airbnb: *What time can I check in? How do I get the key? Where do I leave the trash?*

Pronunciation focus: vowel length — *ship / sheep, sit / seat, live / leave, full / fool*. "I want to **leave**" vs "I want to **live**" causes real confusion at hotels! Also the dangerous pairs **sheet / beach / piece** — make the long vowel clearly long.

Grammar-in-action: "There is / there are" + "isn't / aren't" (describing problems). **"Would it be possible…?"** as a chunk.

Role-plays:

1. Check-in at a hotel (teacher asks for card, ID, explains breakfast and elevator).
2. Calling the front desk with a problem.
3. *Surprise:* "Sorry, we don't have your reservation." Student must stay calm, show confirmation, ask for a solution.

Homework: Watch a hotel check-in dialogue on YouTube twice — first with subtitles, then without. Shadow it (repeat right after the speaker, see section 9).

Brazilian trap: *"I want to make a reclamation."* → **"I'd like to make a complaint."** · *"Push"* on doors means **empurre** (not "puxe" — that's *pull*).

WEEK 6 — Restaurants, Cafés & Shopping

Can-do goal: "I can order food, ask about the menu, pay, and shop for clothes or souvenirs."

Core chunks — restaurant:

- A table for two, please. / We have a reservation.
- Could we see the menu? / What do you recommend?
- What comes with that? / Is it spicy?
- I'll have the ___. / Could I get the ___, please?
- Can I have it without onions? / I'm allergic to ___.
- **Could we get the check, please?** (US) / **the bill** (UK)
- Is the tip included?

Listening — fast phrases they WILL hear:

- *For here or to go?* · *What can I get you?* · *Anything else?* · *How would you like your steak?* · *Still or sparkling?* · *Are you still working on that?* (= have you finished?) · *Do you want a box?* · *Paper or plastic?*

Core chunks — shopping:

- I'm just looking, thanks.
- Do you have this in a medium / in blue / in a bigger size?
- Can I try it on? Where are the fitting rooms?
- How much is this? / Is this on sale?
- Can I pay by card? / Do you take cash?
- I'd like to return this. I have the receipt.

Culture note: tipping in the US is 15–20% at sit-down restaurants and is expected, not optional. Sales tax is added at the register (the price tag is not the final price). Students are always surprised — explain both.

Pronunciation focus: final -ED — *worked (t), played (d), wanted (id).* Brazilians say "work-ed" for all. Drill: *I ordered, I asked, I wanted, I liked, I paid.*

Role-plays:

1. Coffee shop counter (teacher speaks VERY fast, like a real barista).
2. Sit-down restaurant: order, special request, wrong dish arrives, ask for the check.
3. Clothing store: wrong size, exchange, payment.

Homework: Order something in English for real if possible (online menu, or a voice note pretending to order from a real US restaurant menu found online).

Brazilian trap: *"I'm going to take a coffee."* → **"I'll have a coffee."** / *"Can I get a coffee?"* · *"exquisite"* ≠ esquisito (= **weird/strange**). *"Lunch"* is almoço, not lanche (= **snack**).

WEEK 7 — Getting Around: Directions, Transport, Uber, Tickets

Can-do goal: "I can find my way, buy tickets, use transport, and ask strangers for directions."

Core chunks:

- Excuse me, how do I get to ___? / Is it far from here?
- Is there a subway station / a pharmacy near here?
- Can I walk there? How long does it take?
- **Understanding directions:** go straight · turn left/right · it's on your left · at the corner · two blocks down · across from · next to · you can't miss it.
- A one-way / round-trip ticket to ___, please.
- Which platform? / Does this train go to ___? / Which stop do I get off at?
- **Uber/taxi:** Hi, are you ___ (driver's name)? / Could you take me to this address? / Could you turn on the air, please? / You can drop me off here.
- Renting a car: I have a reservation. Is insurance included? Where do I return it? What kind of gas does it take?

Pronunciation focus: word stress and linking — how natives connect words: *"Turn_it off", "Get_out", "Take_a left", "What_are you…"* → *"Whaddaya"*. This is a **listening** focus: students understand slow English but not connected English.

Grammar-in-action: imperatives (*Go, Turn, Take*) and **"How do I…?" / "Where can I…?"**

Role-plays:

1. Map role-play: use Google Maps on screen; teacher gives directions, student traces the route.
2. Swap: student gives directions to the teacher-tourist.
3. Subway ticket machine / station attendant.
4. *Surprise:* the Uber driver is going the wrong way / the train is canceled.

Homework: "Virtual walk": open Google Street View in a city you'll visit. Record yourself describing the route from your hotel to a landmark.

Brazilian trap: *"I'm going to catch an Uber"* (OK!) — but *"I lost the bus"* → **"I missed the bus."** · *"Pretend"* = fingir (not "pretender" → **intend / plan**).

WEEK 8 — Problems & Emergencies ⭐ CHECKPOINT 2

Can-do goal: "If something goes wrong, I can explain it and get help."

Core chunks — health:

- I don't feel well. / I need to see a doctor.
- I have a headache / a stomachache / a fever / a sore throat.
- My ___ hurts. / It hurts here.
- It started yesterday. / It's getting worse.
- I take medication for blood pressure / diabetes. *(prepare the student's real medication list in English!)*
- I'm allergic to penicillin.
- **Pharmacy:** Do I need a prescription for this? How many should I take? / Can you recommend something for ___?

Core chunks — problems:

- I lost my passport / wallet / phone. / Someone stole my bag.
- Where is the nearest police station? / I need to report a theft.
- I need to call the Brazilian consulate.
- Help! / Call 911! *(US — and know the number for each country they'll visit)*
- Can I use your phone? My battery died.
- My card isn't working. / The ATM kept my card.
- My luggage didn't arrive. *(lost baggage claim)*

Pronunciation focus: review of all previous points in emergency phrases — under stress, students go back to Portuguese habits. Practice saying these **fast and under pressure**.

Role-plays:

1. Doctor / urgent care: describe symptoms, history, allergies.
2. Pharmacy counter.
3. Police report for a stolen bag (who, what, when, where).
4. Lost luggage desk at the airport.

CHECKPOINT 2 (Session C): "Bad day" chain role-play — 15 minutes, no phrase sheet: luggage lost → hotel problem → feeling sick → pharmacy. Score with rubric.

Homework: Create a personal **Emergency Card** in English (blood type, medications, allergies, emergency contact, hotel address, insurance phone). The student should actually carry it on the trip.

Brazilian trap: *"I'm with headache"* → **"I have a headache."** · *"I'm constipated"* — be careful! In English it means *intestine preso*, not a cold. A cold is **"I have a cold / I'm congested."** (This one creates very

funny moments at pharmacies — teach it.)

WEEK 9 — Small Talk & Making Friends

Can-do goal: "I can start, keep and finish a casual conversation with a stranger."

Core chunks — the 3 parts of small talk:

- **Start:** Beautiful day, isn't it? / Is this your first time here? / Where are you from? / I love your ___. / Is this seat taken?
- **Keep it going:** Oh really? / That's interesting! / How was it? / What do you like most about ___? / Me too! / Me neither.
- **Finish politely:** Well, it was really nice talking to you. / I have to go, but enjoy your trip! / Have a good one!
- **Safe topics:** weather, the trip, food, the city, family, sports (football = soccer in the US!), travel.
- **Topics to avoid with strangers:** money, salary, age, weight, religion, politics.

Pronunciation focus: intonation — Brazilians often sound flat or "angry" in English. Practice rising intonation for interest (*"Oh, really?"* ↗) and the friendly falling-rising tone of *"That's nice!"*

Grammar-in-action: tag questions as chunks (*isn't it? / aren't you? / don't you?*) and **follow-up questions** — the skill that makes a conversation last.

Role-plays:

1. Waiting in line at a museum.
2. Breakfast at the hotel — another guest sits at your table.
3. A tour group / cruise dinner table.
4. **"Keep it alive" game:** teacher answers with short replies; the student must keep the conversation going for 3 minutes using follow-up questions.

Free talk: Brazil questions foreigners always ask — *What's Brazil like? Is it safe? What should I eat there? Do you dance samba?* Prepare 30-second answers about **your own city and Brazilian culture** — they WILL be asked.

Homework: Talk to one real English speaker (online language exchange app, a tourist in your city, an international video call). Report back in class.

Brazilian trap: *"Actually"* = na verdade (NOT "atualmente" → **currently / nowadays**). *"Eventually"* = finalmente / com o tempo (NOT "eventualmente" → **occasionally**).

WEEK 10 — Telling Stories: Talking About the Past

Can-do goal: "I can tell a story — what happened on my trip, a memory, my life."

Core chunks — story connectors (more important than grammar!):

- First… Then… After that… Finally…
- So… / Because… / But… / Suddenly…

- The best part was… / The funny thing is…
- It was amazing / terrible / unforgettable.
- **Listener reactions:** No way! / Seriously? / What happened next? / That's crazy!

Grammar-in-action: simple past — but only the **25 most common irregular verbs** as chunks: *went, had, saw, ate, took, got, made, came, gave, said, told, felt, found, bought, left, met, paid, spent, thought, knew, slept, drove, flew, wrote, lost.* Use them in mini-stories, not lists.

- Past questions: *Did you…? Where did you go? What did you see?*
- **"used to"** for life memories: *When I was young, I used to…*

Pronunciation focus: final **-ED** again (recycle from W6) + irregular verbs that Brazilians mispronounce: *bought, thought, caught* (no "ou" sound), *said* ("sed", not "say-d").

Role-plays:

1. **"How was your trip?"** — friend back home asks about every detail.
2. **"Tell me about your life"** — the student tells their life story in 3 minutes (prepared, then improvised with interruptions).
3. Photo story: student brings 5 real photos from their phone and tells the story behind each.

Homework: Record a 2-minute story: "The best trip of my life" or "A funny thing that happened to me". Send on WhatsApp; you give audio feedback with 3 points.

Brazilian trap: *"I was in Paris last year and I knowed…"* → **"I went to Paris last year and I met…"** · *"Yesterday I go"* — Brazilians forget the past form when nervous. Drill with "yesterday / last week / ago".

WEEK 11 — Opinions, Plans & Preferences

Can-do goal: "I can give my opinion, talk about plans, agree and disagree politely."

Core chunks:

- **Opinions:** I think… / In my opinion… / For me… / I'm not sure, but…
- **Agree / disagree:** I agree. / Exactly! / I see your point, but… / I'm not so sure about that.
- **Preferences:** I prefer ___ to ___. / I'd rather ___. / I'm (not) a big fan of ___.
- **Plans:** I'm going to visit… / I'm planning to… / I'd love to… / I'm thinking about…
- **Comparing:** It's bigger / cheaper / more expensive / better than… / The best ___ I've ever…
- **Hypothetical (light):** If I had more time, I would… / What would you do if…?

Grammar-in-action: going to (plans) vs **will** (decisions now / promises); comparatives & superlatives as chunks; **"would"** for wishes.

Role-plays:

1. **Planning a day trip** with a travel companion: you disagree on where to go; negotiate.
2. **Travel agent:** compare two packages, ask questions, choose.
3. **Mini-debate** (gentle topics): beach or mountains? Cruise or road trip? Big city or small town? Is it better to travel young or old?

Free talk: Where would you live if you could live anywhere? What's on your bucket list? How has your city changed?

Homework: Prepare a 2-minute talk: "My dream trip" (where, why, plan, budget, who with).

Brazilian trap: *"Do you want that I help you?"* → **"Do you want me to help you?"** · *"I'm thinking in going"* → **"I'm thinking about going."** · *"Depends"* → **"It depends."**

WEEK 12 — Final Interview, Real-World Mission & Graduation ⭐ FINAL

Can-do goal: "I can handle a full trip and a full conversation in English."

Session A — Mega review: 30-minute "Full Trip Simulation" with no phrase sheets: check-in → immigration → Uber → hotel → restaurant → problem → small talk. Teacher changes character every 5 minutes.

Session B — Real-World Mission: the student completes **one real** interaction in English, live:

- a video call with a native/fluent friend of yours (arrange in advance — a 10-minute "interview" with a real stranger is the best final test there is), OR
- calling a real US/UK hotel or store with a real question (opening hours, prices), OR
- a recorded conversation with a tourist in the student's city.

Session C — Final assessment & graduation:

1. Recorded **final interview** (15 min): self-introduction (2 min) + immigration interview (5 min) + story (3 min) + free conversation (5 min).
2. Score with the rubric — compare with Diagnostic and Checkpoints 1 & 2.
3. **Play the Day 1 recording, then today's.** (Prepare tissues. Seriously.)
4. Give the certificate (see **File 5 (Student Sheets)**) and a personalized **"Next 3 months on your own"** plan: daily shadowing, 1 series to watch with English subtitles, 1 conversation per week, review of the "My Story" card.
5. Ask for a testimonial (written or video) and for referrals.

7. Assessment & progress tracking

Speaking rubric (score 1–5 per area, use at Diagnostic, W4, W8, W12)

Area	1	3	5
Fluency / confidence	Freezes, long silences, switches to Portuguese	Pauses but continues; uses "let me think"	Speaks steadily, recovers from mistakes alone

Area	1	3	5
Comprehension	Needs everything repeated slowly	Understands at moderate speed, asks for repetition sometimes	Understands natural speed in familiar situations
Vocabulary / chunks	Isolated words	Uses course chunks in prepared situations	Uses chunks flexibly in unexpected situations
Accuracy	Errors block meaning	Errors are frequent but meaning is clear	Few errors, rarely affect meaning
Pronunciation	Often not understood	Understood with some effort	Easily understood; Brazilian accent is fine!
Interaction	Only answers, never asks	Asks simple questions back	Keeps the conversation going, reacts naturally

Total /30. Typical journey: Diagnostic 8–12 → W4 13–16 → W8 17–20 → W12 20–25.

> **Accent is not a mistake.** The goal is to be *understood*, not to sound American. Tell students this explicitly — it removes a lot of fear.

Weekly self-check (student, 2 minutes, end of Session C)

"This week I can…" — 3 can-do statements with 😟 / 🙂 / 😄. See **File 5 (Student Sheets)**.

Teacher's log (per session, 2 lines)

Date · what we did · 3 errors noted · 1 win · next focus. Keeping this makes you look (and be) very professional, and it's the source of your feedback messages.

8. Teaching older adults — what works

- **Lower anxiety first.** Many had bad school experiences with English. Say early: "Mistakes are the price of speaking. In here, mistakes are free."
- **Use their life.** They have 40+ years of stories, jobs and opinions — use them. Never use children's materials or childish topics.
- **Slower pace for new input, but many repetitions.** Memory works best with spaced repetition: review each chunk 1 day, 3 days, 1 week, 2 weeks later (the "Recycle" block does this).
- **Physical and visual.** Big-font printed phrase sheets, real objects (passport, menu, boarding pass printouts), acting out situations standing up.

- **Hearing:** check if they hear you well (online: headphones are mandatory). Speak clearly, face the camera.
- **Technology:** help them set up WhatsApp audio, YouTube subtitles, Google Translate's conversation mode as a *backup* — explain everything simply.
- **Celebrate concrete wins.** "Last month you couldn't answer that question. Today you answered in 3 seconds." Specific praise works; general praise doesn't.
- **Respect their pace with a deadline.** If a trip date exists, focus ruthlessly on what that trip needs.

9. Homework system (15 min/day)

Older adults with a busy life do homework when it's **short, clear and daily**. Send it on WhatsApp after each class.

Day	15-minute task
Mon	Review the phrase sheet out loud (not silently!) — 3 times
Tue	**Shadowing:** play a 1-minute dialogue; repeat each sentence right after the speaker, copying speed and melody
Wed	Record a voice message using 5 phrases of the week
Thu	Watch 10 min of a series/YouTube in English with **English** subtitles; write 3 phrases
Fri	Update the "My Story" card and read it aloud
Sat/Sun	Free: talk to yourself in English while doing chores ("Now I'm cooking rice…")

Suggested free resources (check that they're still available before recommending): YouTube channels with real-life travel dialogues, podcasts for learners at slow speed, the subtitles feature on Netflix/YouTube, language-exchange apps for Week 9.

10. Running this as a business

> Practical notes for Di. Prices below are a *framework*, not market data — check what other private teachers in your city / on platforms charge before deciding.

Offer structure (example):

- **Free diagnostic** (30–45 min) — this is your sales meeting. At the end, show them their score and the 12-week map, and what they'll be able to do.
- **Full program** — 36 sessions, 12 weeks, paid monthly (3 payments) or upfront with a discount.
- **Express "Trip in 4 weeks"** — Weeks 1, 3, 4, 5–8 compressed (for students with a close trip date).

- **Interview-only package** — 6 sessions of mock interviews (immigration / job interview in English).
- **Pairs** (couples traveling together!) — slightly higher total price, lower per person. Couples are a great niche for this program.

Where students come from:

- Your own network in Brazil: family, friends, church, community groups, WhatsApp groups of retirees.
- Travel agencies — offer a partnership: "your clients travel more confidently".
- Facebook / Instagram posts with (permitted) before/after audio clips.
- Online: Zoom/Google Meet allows you to teach from anywhere — Brazil or the US.

Your strongest selling point: you are a Brazilian who **lived and worked in the US for years** in healthcare — you've actually been through the airport, the immigration line, the doctor's office and the job interview in English. You understand exactly where Brazilians get stuck because you've been there. Say that in every pitch.

Materials you'll need (all included in these files or easy to make): phrase sheets per week (print from this book), the student forms, a video-call setup with good audio, a WhatsApp group or chat per student for homework.